the antagonistic attitude aside. Another crucial aspect of the BRICS is that no BRICS members cross redlines of the group principles. For instance, due to the different views on the Venezuela incidents in 2019 and Brazil's continental leadership ambitions, the Venezuela issue was left out of the BRICS final declarations. That is how India and China border disputes also have no place to be part of the BRICS discussions (Panova 2021). It indicates that the bilateral contradictions may not hinder the progress of the BRICS group. The BRICS group members signal that they do not want to go away from the BRICS group.

Chinese Perspective on BRICS: Institutional, Not Oppositional

The Chinese Foreign Minister Yang Jiechi (2011), while responding to questions from a reporter, claimed that the BRICS cooperation is open and very inclusive and that the critical aspect of the group is that it would cement North–South cooperation (Consulate General of the Peoples Republic of China in San Francisco 2011). Further, a Chinese foreign ministry affiliated think tank affirmed that 'BRICS is an ad-hoc political group and is not an anti-US bloc' (Gordon 2011). While giving a written answer to the media on March 28, 2012, the Chinese president Hu Jintao stated that the 'BRICS group is the defender and promoter of the southern world countries in the coming period' (Embassy of the People's Republic of China in Republic of India 2012), BRICS has very prominence position in Chinese foreign policy as it can diversify economic development goals with other major developing countries. Further, China would bolster its relations with these countries, unlike earlier periods (Yue 2013).

According to Li Lianmin (2014), a research fellow of Russian Studies at the Chinese Academy of Social sciences, BRICS should become a strategic cooperative mechanism of greater binding power among developing countries (Xinhua 2014). Scholar Cheng (2015) observed that after the Cold War, the international relations system power was configured by one superpower country and several major powers. However, the global combat of terrorism and the 2008–2009 financial crisis had reduced the predominance of the United States in international relations. Further, the wars of Afghanistan and Iraq had proved too costly to handle. So it is in this